Yasir A. Malik

Newark, New Jersey · ____________________ · ____________________

Morgan Stanley — Model Validation, Investment Management and Wealth Management, Executive Director

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing regarding the Executive Director role in Model Validation for Investment Management and Wealth Management.

Most of my career has been spent on the challenge side of models rather than the build side. I began as a bank examiner with the OCC and a state regulator, then spent fifteen years in audit and risk at JPMorgan Chase and Citigroup. At JPMorgan Chase I owned Basel III RWA and CCAR reporting across the derivatives, loan, and securities portfolios, filed FR Y-14Q, FFIEC 101, and Pillar 3, and identified $180 million in capital optimization — work where model output had to survive supervisory challenge line by line, with the assumptions and the data lineage behind it. I also led Resolution and Recovery Planning, coordinating more than fifty stakeholders through Federal Reserve and FDIC submissions. At Citigroup, as a VP Audit Manager, I ran thematic reviews across more than fifteen business units and built the risk and issue reporting that went to the Board Audit Committee.

What I would add to a validation team is that I have also been on the other side of the exercise. At Citi I designed and deployed a retrieval-augmented AI review assistant that cut review cycle time by roughly 35%, and I wrote the governance framework proposal for it, referencing the NIST AI Risk Management Framework and SR 11-7. Building that system taught me things about model documentation, data dependency, and failure modes that reading validation reports had not. It is a useful pair of perspectives to hold at once as investment management and wealth platforms take on more machine learning.

The third piece is my doctoral research at Florida International University, where I passed the qualifying examination in July 2026. I study automation bias in professional judgment — specifically what happens to a reviewer's judgment when a model's output arrives before the reviewer has formed their own. A confident output presented early becomes the anchor, and the reviewer's independent conclusion narrows around it. The consequence is that a model can pass every performance test in the validation plan and still degrade the quality of the decisions made around it, because the sequence in which its output reaches a human is itself a control. Benchmark testing, backtesting, and sensitivity analysis do not detect that. Control design does, and it is the part of model risk I would want to work on here.

I would welcome a conversation about how the team is approaching validation of AI and machine learning models in the wealth and investment management businesses.

Sincerely, Yasir A. Malik _____________________ · _____________________